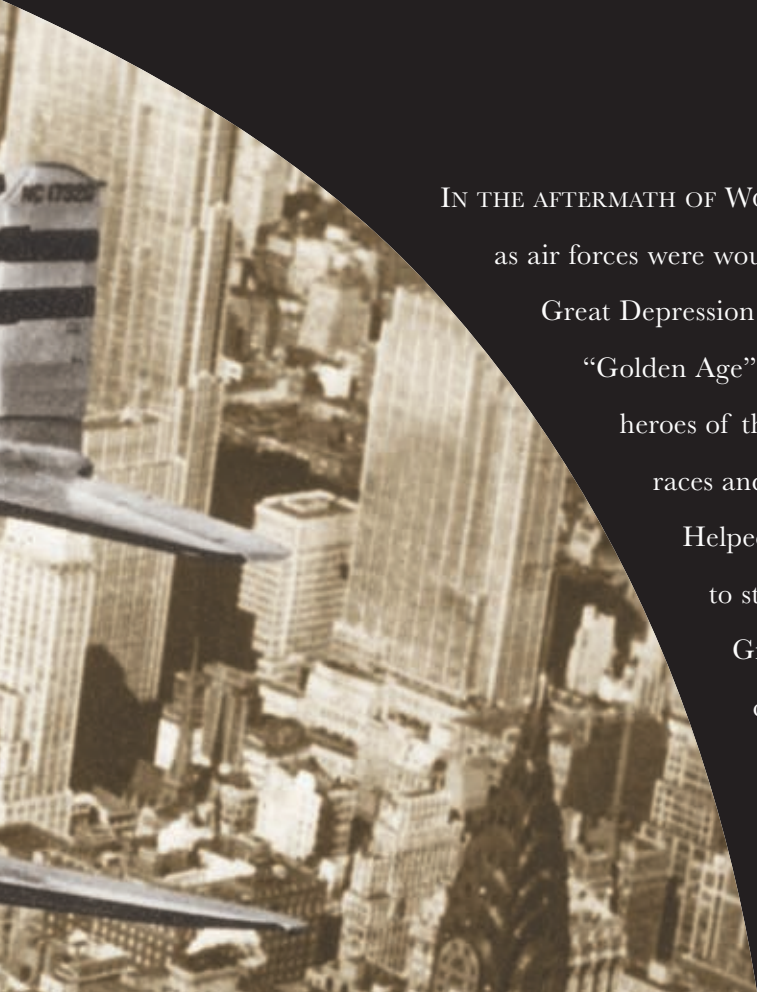


THE GOLDEN AGE

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IN THE AFTERMATH OF WORLD WAR I, aircraft manufacturers struggled to survive as air forces were wound down. But, defying the postwar recession and the Great Depression that followed, the 1920s and 1930s blossomed into a “Golden Age” of aviation. Pilots were among the most celebrated heroes of the day, and the public thrilled to the excitement of air races and the feats of Charles Lindbergh and Amelia Earhart. Helped by pioneering long-distance survey flights, airlines began to stretch their networks across and between continents. Great airships brought unparalleled luxury to air travel, challenged only by the stately flying boats. The advent of sleek all-metal monoplanes led to radical advances in speed and range, while improved flight instruments and navigation devices made aircraft increasingly safe to fly.



STREAMLINED SUPERSTAR

This aerial view of a TWA Douglas DC-3 passenger airplane shows it flying over midtown Manhattan. The DC-3, which came into service in the mid-1930s, could carry 21 passengers and marked a turning point in aviation by making a profit on passenger services alone.

